COMMERCIAL · EVIDENCE

Product-market fit

Whether anyone wants this, what proof would look like, and how to get that proof in ninety days. Written for one person with a working app and no paying users.

WHERE WE ACTUALLY STAND **There is no evidence of a real user anywhere in this project.** Every persona and pain point in the strategy documents is founder judgement, not something observed. That is normal at this stage. It also means the entire case rests on one person's instinct, which is the most common way early products misread their market. Nothing here claims Family Hub has fit. It is a plan to find out.

01 · THE WEDGE

One job, one age band

THE WEDGE Turning a paper chore chart and hand-counted pocket money into a system where a child aged roughly **6 to 11** earns, sees, and decides what to do with their own money, for a parent who already does this by hand and is tired of it.

The strategy leads with "the operating system for modern family life". That is broader and weaker, for a reason visible in the repository itself:

- The habit-to-money loop has had **a dozen or more refinement tickets**: the money row, investment tags, contrast, the value-over-time maths, the action sheets. That is where the product has a real opinion.
- Meals, calendar, noticeboard and assignments have **no feature document at all**. They are competent, and undifferentiated.

The product already voted with its effort. The positioning should follow it.

Stated so it can be proved wrong

Among parents of a 6 to 11 year old who currently run pocket money by hand, at least **40% of households that activate** will, in a second consecutive week, have the child both complete a habit **and** take a money action, and will describe it unprompted as better than what they did before. If that is false, the money layer is decoration on a sticker chart.

02 · THE BET

The one thing that decides everything

READING	THE CASE FOR IT
It is a moat	Three ideas proven separately (loss aversion, money staked on consistency, children investing) that nobody has assembled for families, plausibly because the kids' money companies were all consumed by card and banking regulation
It is a mistake	**No data exists anywhere** on whether shrinking a child's tracked value for a missed habit improves the habit, or just produces resentment and a deleted app. A penalty on a child's money can read badly out of context, however safe it is technically

This must be tested on real children before it becomes the headline. It is the first thing to learn, not the first thing to advertise.

03 · PROOF

What would count, and what would not

Activation has to mean two people, not one. A grown-up finishes signup, adds a child, sets a habit, **and** the child signs in with their own PIN and completes a habit, within seven days. The product does not work if only the adult shows up.

MEASURE	GREEN	AMBER	RED, STOP
Signup to activation, within 7 days	50%+	25 to 50%	under 15%
Week 2 return with a habit done	40%+	20 to 40%	under 20%
Week 4 return with a habit done	25%+	15 to 25%	under 10%
A money action after week 1	30%+	15 to 30%	under 10%

Track the last two separately, never blended. "Earns again in week 2" only proves we beat a paper chart, which plenty of chore apps already do. "Takes a money action after week 1" is the only one that tests what we are actually selling. If the first is healthy and the second is not, we have built a nicer sticker chart.

04 · RISK

The riskiest assumptions, in order

THE ASSUMPTION	WHY IT IS THIS HIGH	THE CHEAPEST TEST
1. Both a grown-up and a child turn up, or nothing happens	The precondition for every other number	Personally onboard 15 to 20 families on a call, and watch whether the child's first session happens
2. The pain is bad enough that a parent finishes setup	If the paper chart is tolerable, nobody switches	15 to 20 interviews before showing the app
3. Parents hand over the real money the app says they owe	We move no money and issue no card. Entirely trust	One line a week: did anything get cashed out, did you pay it
4. An eight-year-old understands "invest"	If only the parent gets it, it is a parent feature in a child's costume	Five minutes with 5 to 8 children: ask them to explain it back
5. "It can lose value" does not alarm the parent	A perception risk, separate from technical safety	Ask directly how the language reads
6. Families want one app, not the best of each	Decides whether the six grown-up tabs earn their place	Ask which tool they would actually stop using

05 · AGAINST

The honest case against

- **Too broad, for one person.** Six grown-up tabs, a child's world, learning games and an intricate money engine, before a single person has paid. Deep in one place, thin everywhere else, pitched as a whole operating system.
- **The headline claim does not survive a check.** Positioning leads with understanding twins and step-children. The database has no field for either.
- **The financial projections are imaginary.** Billing is an empty placeholder, and the strategy projects $720k of annual revenue inside 24 months.
- **Money plus children has no second impression.** "Invest" and "can lose value" applied to a child read badly out of context, whatever the technical reality.
- **The wedge is not empty water.** Greenlight, Acorns Early, Rooster Money and BusyKid already own "children plus chores plus money", several with real cards and years of trust.
- **There is no evidence of a real user anywhere in the project.** Every persona is founder judgement, not observation. Normal at this stage, and the most common way early products misread their market.

06 · PLAN

Ninety days, one person

01	**Days 0 to 30**	**Does anyone turn up, and is the pain real.** Recruit 15 to 20 families through warm channels only, skewed to a child aged 6 to 11. Interview before demoing. Onboard every family personally. **Gate:** 8 activate, 5 return in week 2 with a habit done.
02	**Days 31 to 60**	**Does the money loop land.** Grow to 40 to 60 by referral, which doubles as a free test of whether families invite families. Run the child think-aloud on the invest screen. Ask directly about $7.99. **Gate:** week 4 retention 15 to 20%+, a money action after week 1 in 30%+.
03	**Days 61 to 90**	**Does anyone actually pay.** Charge 10 to 15 of the most engaged families for real, even at a discount. In parallel run a stripped signup, habit tracker and money only, on 10 to 15 new families. **Decision:** 3 to 5 paying plus holding retention is a green light for one paid channel.

07 · FOCUS

What to cut from the pitch

About the pitch and the default onboarding, not about deleting working code.

FEATURE	VERDICT	WHY
Habit tracker and stickers	**Keep, it is the core**	Everything depends on it
Kids money: save, invest, spend	**Keep, make it the hero**	Where the depth and the difference live
Child PIN sign-in	Keep	Required for the wedge to work at all
Calendar	Keep, reframe	"This week's habits", not a Cozi replacement
Meals	**Out of the pitch**	A commodity job AnyList and Mealime own, with no link to the wedge
Noticeboard	**Out of the pitch**	WhatsApp wins, and inside one family there is nobody to broadcast to
Assignments and Tasks	Merge or hide one	Same job, two tabs invites the confusion the money redesign just fixed
Learning games	Keep shipped, out of the pitch	A third product competing with Khan Academy
Organisation and white-label	**Freeze**	Chasing a second buyer before the first has retention data

Family Hub · Product-market fit · 8 August 2026 · No paying customers, no live billing, no evidence yet